

Hybrid & Remote Work Policy – California Employees

Purpose

This policy establishes expectations, responsibilities, and requirements for hybrid and remote work arrangements while supporting collaboration, flexibility, productivity, employee well-being, information security, and compliance with California employment laws. The Company recognizes that flexible work arrangements can improve employee satisfaction, support work-life balance, enhance business continuity, and attract and retain talent. At the same time, remote and hybrid work arrangements require clear expectations, accountability, communication, and adherence to Company standards. This policy provides comprehensive guidance regarding eligibility, approvals, performance expectations, technology requirements, security responsibilities, reimbursement practices, and management oversight.

The Company expects employees and managers to work collaboratively to ensure that remote and hybrid work arrangements remain effective, equitable, secure, and aligned with business objectives. Regular communication, accountability, professionalism, and flexibility are essential components of successful implementation.

Company Work Model

The Company operates primarily on-site in San Diego, California. Employees may be eligible for approved hybrid or flexible remote work arrangements based on business needs and job responsibilities. The Company believes in maintaining a collaborative culture while providing flexibility where appropriate. Remote work is considered a business arrangement rather than an employee entitlement and may be modified or revoked at any time based on operational requirements.

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Eligibility

Eligibility for remote or hybrid work depends on numerous factors, including job responsibilities, performance history, operational requirements, customer needs, team collaboration requirements, security considerations, regulatory obligations, and managerial discretion. Positions requiring frequent in-person interaction, access to specialized equipment, physical handling of products, or on-site customer support may not be eligible for remote work. Human Resources and management are responsible for determining eligibility.

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Approval Process

Employees interested in hybrid or remote work arrangements must submit a formal request for management review. Requests should include the proposed schedule, work location, business justification, and any anticipated equipment or support needs. Managers will evaluate requests based on productivity, team needs, communication requirements, and operational considerations. Approval may be temporary, ongoing, or conditional.

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Hybrid Work Expectations

Employees approved for hybrid work arrangements are expected to maintain regular in-office attendance according to their approved schedule. Employees must attend required meetings, participate in team activities, remain accessible during working hours, and maintain productivity standards equivalent to on-site employees. Hybrid schedules may be adjusted periodically to support changing business priorities.

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Flexible Remote Work Arrangements

Flexible remote work arrangements may be approved for temporary personal circumstances, business continuity needs, project assignments, alternate schedules, or ongoing work arrangements. Approval is not guaranteed and depends on operational requirements. Employees must continue to meet all performance, communication, and attendance expectations while working remotely.

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Work Hours and Availability

Remote and hybrid employees are expected to maintain their approved work schedules and remain available during designated working hours. Employees should respond promptly to communications, participate in meetings, and collaborate effectively with coworkers.

Nonexempt employees must accurately record all hours worked and comply with meal and rest break requirements.

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Communication Standards

Effective communication is critical to the success of remote and hybrid work arrangements. Employees are expected to maintain reliable communication channels, respond to messages within reasonable timeframes, attend scheduled meetings, keep calendars updated, and proactively communicate project status, challenges, and availability. Managers should establish communication expectations for their teams.

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Performance Expectations

Remote and hybrid employees are held to the same performance standards as employees working on-site. Productivity, quality, responsiveness, customer service, collaboration, and professionalism remain essential job requirements. Performance evaluations will focus on results, achievement of goals, and adherence to Company expectations regardless of work location.

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Workspace Requirements

Employees working remotely must maintain a safe, secure, and professional workspace suitable for performing assigned duties. Workspaces should be free from excessive distractions, support confidentiality requirements, and provide adequate lighting, ergonomics, and internet connectivity. Employees are responsible for maintaining appropriate working conditions.

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Equipment and Technology

The Company may provide approved equipment such as laptops, monitors, docking stations, keyboards, headsets, webcams, software licenses, and other tools necessary to perform job duties. All Company-issued equipment remains Company property and must be used primarily for business purposes. Employees are responsible for safeguarding Company assets and reporting damage, loss, or theft promptly.

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Information Security

Protection of Company information is a critical responsibility. Employees must comply with all cybersecurity, privacy, confidentiality, and data protection requirements. Employees must use Company-approved systems, enable multi-factor authentication, utilize VPN access when required, maintain updated software, protect passwords, and avoid unauthorized sharing of confidential information.

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Confidentiality

Employees working remotely must ensure that confidential information is protected from unauthorized access. Business conversations, documents, computer screens, and electronic communications should not be visible or accessible to household members, visitors, or unauthorized individuals. Employees remain subject to all confidentiality obligations regardless of work location.

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Expense Reimbursement

The Company complies with California reimbursement requirements for necessary business expenses associated with remote work. Reimbursable expenses may include approved equipment, required software, business-related internet costs, communication expenses, and other necessary expenditures. Employees should follow the Company's Expense Reimbursement Policy and obtain approval before incurring significant expenses.

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Health and Safety

Remote employees are responsible for maintaining a safe work environment. Employees should follow ergonomic best practices, maintain appropriate workstation setups, promptly report work-related injuries, and comply with applicable safety requirements. The Company may provide guidance regarding ergonomic assessments and workplace safety practices.

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Training and Development

Remote and hybrid employees remain eligible for training, professional development, mentorship opportunities, and career advancement. Managers should ensure that remote employees receive equitable access to development opportunities and are included in learning initiatives, team discussions, and organizational communications.

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Work Location Restrictions

Employees may not permanently work outside California without prior approval due to tax, payroll, legal, employment, and compliance considerations. Temporary work from another location may require approval depending on duration, business impact, and legal requirements. Employees must notify management before changing their primary work location.

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Business Continuity

Hybrid and remote work arrangements support business continuity and operational resilience. Employees may be required to work remotely during emergencies, severe weather events, facility disruptions, public health events, or other situations affecting normal business operations. Employees should maintain readiness to support continuity plans when necessary.

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Manager Responsibilities

Managers play a critical role in the success of remote and hybrid work programs. Managers are responsible for establishing expectations, monitoring performance, supporting communication, ensuring inclusion, evaluating requests fairly, and addressing issues promptly. Managers should focus on outcomes, accountability, and employee engagement.

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Human Resources Responsibilities

Human Resources is responsible for administering this policy, supporting managers and employees, providing guidance regarding employment law compliance, maintaining documentation, reviewing requests, and ensuring consistent policy application. Human Resources may periodically review remote work arrangements to ensure continued effectiveness.

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Policy Violations

Failure to comply with this policy may result in corrective action, modification of work arrangements, revocation of remote work privileges, or disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment. Examples include failure to maintain productivity, security violations, unauthorized work locations, misuse of Company equipment, or repeated communication failures.

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Frequently Asked Questions

Employees should consult their manager or Human Resources whenever questions arise regarding eligibility, reimbursement, work schedules, security requirements, equipment, workplace safety, or interpretation of this policy. Seeking guidance before issues arise helps ensure successful remote work arrangements.

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Policy Administration

The Company reserves the right to revise, modify, suspend, or discontinue this policy at any time, subject to applicable law. Nothing in this policy creates a contract of employment or alters the at-will employment relationship. Employees are responsible for complying with the most current version of the policy.

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Appendix 1: Remote Work Best Practices

Employees should maintain organized workspaces, establish clear boundaries between work and personal responsibilities, participate actively in meetings, document key decisions, maintain strong cybersecurity practices, proactively communicate challenges, and collaborate effectively with colleagues. Managers should foster inclusion, recognize achievements, support employee well-being, and ensure that remote team members remain engaged and connected to organizational goals. Employees should maintain organized workspaces, establish clear boundaries between work and personal responsibilities, participate actively in meetings, document key decisions, maintain strong cybersecurity practices, proactively communicate challenges, and collaborate effectively with colleagues. Managers should foster inclusion, recognize achievements, support employee well-being, and ensure that remote team members remain engaged and connected to organizational goals. Employees should maintain organized workspaces, establish clear boundaries between work and personal responsibilities, participate actively in meetings, document key decisions, maintain strong cybersecurity practices, proactively communicate challenges, and collaborate effectively with colleagues. Managers should foster inclusion, recognize achievements, support employee well-being, and ensure that remote team members remain engaged and connected to organizational goals.

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